

A few things I'm learning about GDPR — using just my browser.

No paid tools, no budget — just the inspector your browser already ships with. Sharing what's helped me, in case it's useful to you too. 😊

What the cookie banner taught me.

Try opening DevTools → **Network** → reload, before touching the banner. Anything that loads **before** you click "Accept" loaded without consent. It helped me see how §25 TTDSG plays out in practice.

● ● ● Network – loaded before consent

www.google-analytics.com	200 · fired
connect.facebook.net	200 · fired
consentbanner.js	still open

↳ tracking started before the visitor agreed to anything.

A German server can still be a US question.

Something I didn't expect: add the **Remote Address** column and drop the IP into **ip-api.com**. A US-owned host can mean an Art. 44 transfer even if the box sits in Frankfurt — the CLOUD Act looks past geography.

● ● ● ip-api.com — lookup

35.241.3.184 → Google LLC

US

city → Kansas City

—

Art. 44 GDPR · third-country transfer

The font that surprised me most.

Filtering Network by "**font**" was an eye-opener. If **fonts.gstatic.com** loads, a visitor's IP goes to Google on load. A Munich court awarded €100 in damages over this in 2022 — and the fix is gentle: host the font locally.

● ● ● Network — filter: font

fonts.googleapis.com/css

200 · US

fonts.gstatic.com/...woff2

200 · US

LG München I · 3 0 17493/20 · 20.01.2022

You don't need to master cryptography.

This one was a relief to learn. Paste the domain into **ssllabs.com** and read the letter at the top. Below an A, it's worth a friendly note to the tech team — no need to wade through 30 pages of TLS theory first.

SSL Labs – server test

Overall rating

B

supports TLS 1.0 / 1.1

capped

↳ below A → escalate to the technical contact.

I knew the law before I could **see it happen.**

For a long time I could cite Schrems II but couldn't point to the actual IP address. Learning to open the inspector — to **see** what the words describe — has made the law feel so much more real. If you're on the same path, you're in good company.

IF YOU WANT TO TRY

Maybe pick one site this week.

If it sounds fun, have a look at **one** real website. Note the tracker that fired pre-consent, the US IP, the Google Fonts call, the TLS grade — one page, one line of law per finding.

I've found that actually doing it once teaches me more than weeks of reading. And there's no pressure to get it perfect — it's all learning.

THANKS FOR READING

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CIPP/E & AIGP in progress. Still learning every day — I'd
love to hear what's worked for you.

Let's connect & learn together ↗

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